

The ENERGY Suite

Tool 1: The ENERGY Meter

Overview:

The ENERGY Meter is designed to help a learner (and/or their partners) reflect on their own energy levels in relation to the energy they need or desire for various activities and the environments in which they occur. Just make a rating about where one's energy is, and where they would like it to be. If those two ratings align, we call that regulation; if they do not match, we call that dysregulation. This support, free of emotional labels as well as word and color connotations, is particularly helpful for individuals who do not access the socially constructed abstractions that are emotion words, but it can also be used by those who might access and use emotion words where they feel it fits for them! This support can be used by an individual, but it can also be used interactively and dynamically by partners to provide clear visual feedback related to the person's Energy Needed for the activity and where the individual's current Energy. Remember, if there is a mismatch in energy, a regulatory strategy may be needed (use The Regulator 2.0), or environmental/activity modifications may be more appropriate (use The Person In Context).

"GOs" and "NOs" for Learners and their Partners	
DO use this tool for exploration and curiosity.	Do NOT assume that you know someone's ENERGY if you do not know them well.
DO model language related to your own ENERGY in everyday activities and environments.	Do NOT assume that everyone needs the same ENERGY level to actively engage in an activity.
DO resist the urge to introduce ENERGY by talking about mismatches and the need to regulate. This is a goal to work towards once the language and concepts of ENERGY are familiar.	Do NOT use this tool in directive ways that forces compliance and contributes to masking.
DO respect difference and keep it playful.	Do NOT mix business and pleasure – aka do NOT coopt someone's special interest for teaching this concept.

*We are all learners. Learner is one of the most important roles a human can have. Learners are seekers of knowledge and growth. Partners are trusted support providers for learners. Partners seek to understand the perspective and experience of the learner they are supporting. Partners join in the learning process.

Energy Needed
(Match for the Activity)

My Energy
(Where I Am)

Maxed Out / Frenzied

Amped Up / Fidgety

Single Stream / Flowing

Settled / Calm

Sleepy / Still

Asleep

Sensory System	Power Down	Power UP!
Vestibular (movement/position in space)	<i>Movements that are:</i> ● Rhythmic (e.g., jumping) ● Rocking (e.g., dancing) ● Linear (e.g., walking, climbing stairs) ● Arc (e.g., swinging)	<i>Movements that are:</i> ● Random (e.g., touch toes, playing tag, Simon Says) ● Quick (e.g., sprinting) ● Circular (e.g., swinging) ● Spinning (e.g., dancing)
Proprioceptive (muscle and joint input position/ pressure...) <i>often considered the universal regulatory same input can increase arousal or decrease arousal)</i>	<i>Inputs that provide:</i> ● Passive pressure from trusted individual (e.g., bear hugs, squishes, joint compressions) ● Resistive movement (e.g. carrying items such as backpacks and books, wheelbarrow walking, crab walking, bear walking) ● Passive inputs (e.g., weighted blankets, hug vests) ● Resistive fine motor toys (e.g., play doh, putty, stress balls) ● Oral motor activities (e.g., chewy food/ candy, resistive sucking on straws blowing bubbles, sports bottle)	<i>Inputs that involve:</i> ● Moving and joint compression (e.g., hippity hop, jumping, hop scotch, twister) ● Pushing and Pulling (e.g., vacuuming, shoveling, scooters, carrying objects) ● Passive pressure from trusted individual (e.g., bear hugs, squishes) ● Resistive fine motor toys (e.g., play doh, putty, stress balls) ● Oral motor activities (e.g., chewy food/candy, resistive sucking on straws blowing bubbles, sports bottle)
Tactile (touch)	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Consistent pressure and firm touch (e.g., massage from trusted person or self massage, stroking preferred fabric or surface texture) ● Rhythmic tapping ● Foods that are smooth and soft (e.g., pudding, yogurt, breads)	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Light touch (e.g., tickling by self or trusted person) ● Stroking preferred fabric or surface texture ● Foods that are crisp or crunchy (e.g., pickles, crackers, chips, crisps, pretzels)
Auditory (sound)	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Rhythmic, predictable sounds ● Listening to music with strong, slow and steady beat ● Individual being in control of auditory qualities of the environment	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Unexpected, loud, and random sounds ● Listening to music with quick tempo or improvisational qualities
Gustatory (taste)	<i>Food and drinks that include:</i> ● Mild flavors (e.g., sweet, smooth)	<i>Food and drinks that include:</i> ● Strong flavors (e.g., sour, spicy, salty)
Visual (sight)	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Colors and predictable patterns that are pleasing to an individual (e.g., kaleidoscope)	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Random visual information, rapid movement (e.g., balls being tossed towards person)
Olfactory (smell)	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Familiar pleasant smells to individual	<i>Activities that involve:</i> ● Unfamiliar, pungent, sharp smells

*The appropriateness of these strategies for any given individual should always be considered within the context of that individual's sensory processing profile. They are not universally applicable.